

The Minimum Viable Design Business

One page. One offer. One post a day. The smallest setup that can actually pay you.

Five pillars · Forty-five minutes · Fourteen days to build

NAME

DATE STARTED

READ THIS FIRST

Before you start

This is what I'd tell a friend who could design but couldn't find work. It worked for me, and for people I've watched do it. It is not a guarantee, and it will not make you rich. What it can do is move you from no channel, no offer, waiting to something a stranger can find, understand, and pay for.

HOW TO USE IT

One sitting. About forty-five minutes. Fill it in by hand or on screen — but fill it in. Reading it does nothing.

Every pillar ends with a constraint. The constraints are the entire point. They are the places where you would normally negotiate with yourself, keep your options open, and end up back where you started with a portfolio nobody can buy from. Do not soften them.

THE FIVE PILLARS

01 **Slice** what you do, and who for

02 **Offer** three tiers and a price ladder

03 **Proof** two or three blocks of work

04 **Page** one page with a working button

05 **Volume** one post a day, in your slice

THE WHOLE THING IN ONE LINE

post → profile → link → page → paid

Every decision in this worksheet exists to make that sequence work without you being in the room. If something you're about to build doesn't serve that line, it's for later.

BEFORE YOU TURN THE PAGE

Write today's date, and the date fourteen days from now. That second date is when the button goes live.

Today _____

Live by _____

Your slice

Generic designers get compared on price. Specific designers get compared to nobody.

You are not committing forever. You are committing until the page is built. That's a small enough promise that you can actually make it today.

WRITE YOUR SENTENCE

I design _____ for _____.

what surface — what kind of company

CONSTRAINT

One surface, one type of company. If your sentence needs an "and," cut one side of it.

CALIBRATION

TOO BROAD

SHARP ENOUGH

I design websites for businesses

I design landing pages for B2B SaaS launches

I do UI/UX and branding

I redesign onboarding flows for fintech apps

I help startups with design

I design marketing sites for dev tools

THE TEST

Could someone inside your slice read your sentence and think "that's literally my problem"? If it could describe ten thousand other designers, it isn't done.

REWRITE IT HERE ONCE IT SURVIVES THE TEST

Your offer

Nobody buys “let’s hop on a call and scope it.” They buy a thing with a price on it.

Before the tiers, the entry price. Don't guess it and don't copy someone else's — their market isn't yours. Derive it from two numbers you already know.

DERIVE YOUR ENTRY PRICE

A	What you need to earn each month to keep going	Rent, food, tools. The number, not the dream.
B	How many Tier 1 projects you could genuinely run at once	Be honest. Not your best week.
C	Now subtract one. $C = B - 1$	That slot is your own business — content, process, calls, admin. If you sell it, you stop building.

$A \div C = \text{your entry price}$

ENTRY PRICE

TIER 2 · ABOUT 3× ENTRY

TIER 3 · ABOUT 2× TIER 2

Ratios, not amounts — they travel across currencies and markets in a way fixed numbers never do. If Tier 1 takes two weeks rather than a month, double C before you divide.

If the number looks too low, it's probably honest. It is a floor for staying alive at your current capacity, not a valuation of your work. The ladder on the next page is what moves it.

If it looks too high, your capacity number is optimistic. Lower B and run it again.

Three tiers

One number becomes a menu. The entry price you just derived goes in the first column.

BUILD THREE TIERS

	TIER 1 — ENTRY	TIER 2 — THE PICK	TIER 3 — ANCHOR
NAME			
WHAT THEY GET			
TURNAROUND			
PRICE			

Rules for that table

- Tier 1 is the entry. Price it at a number that makes you slightly uncomfortable — low enough that saying yes takes no thought.
- Tier 2 is the one you want them to pick. Make it the obvious value.
- Tier 3 exists to make Tier 2 look reasonable. It is allowed to be expensive.
- Turnaround is a number of days. Not “depends on scope.”

CONSTRAINT

No custom quotes for your first fifteen clients. If something doesn't fit a tier, decline it or fit it to a tier. Custom quoting is how you go back to being invisible.

The ladder

Raise your prices every five clients delivered. Decide the rungs now, before you have any reason to feel confident — then you never have to decide again.

CLIENTS DELIVERED	TIER 1	TIER 2	TIER 3
0 – 5			
6 – 10			
11 – 15			
16 – 20			
21 – 25			

Why a ladder and not a rate. The reason most designers stay cheap is not that they undercharge once. It's that raising a price requires a decision, and decisions made while you're anxious about rent always come out low. A ladder moves the decision to today, when nothing is at stake.

The trigger is clients delivered, not months passed and not how you feel. Five finished projects is five pieces of proof, five testimonials, and five reasons the next person should pay more.

TRACK THE LADDER

CLIENT	WHAT YOU DELIVERED	PAID	TESTIMONIAL COLLECTED
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

When row five is full, go back to the ladder and move up a rung. Same day. No renegotiating with yourself.

Your proof

Most people stall here, because they think they need case studies. You don't. You need two or three blocks of work that look good and make sense.

WHAT A BLOCK IS

- One line of context — what it is, who it's for
- Three to six visuals — the actual screens, large, well-cropped
- One line of reasoning — what you were solving, or what changed

Eighty per cent visual, twenty per cent text. Nobody reads the paragraph. Everybody reads the pixels.

WHAT COUNTS

- Real client work
- A self-initiated redesign of a product people already know
- A concept you made specifically to show what you'd do

Real and unpaid still counts. Label it — *concept, not shipped* — and move on. Honesty here costs you nothing. The alternative costs you everything, once.

YOUR BLOCKS

BLOCK 1

BLOCK 2

BLOCK 3

WHAT IT IS

VISUALS READY

THE ONE LINE

REAL OR CONCEPT

CONSTRAINT

If you have fewer than two blocks ready, your next three days are making one. Not outreach. Not the page. Just the work.

One warning. If all three blocks look like the same template with different colours, you've shown one thing three times. Vary the layout, the type, the density, the rhythm. Sameness across a portfolio reads as "I use a system I bought," not "I have judgement." It is the single most common reason good work fails to convert.

Your page

One page. Not a site, not a blog. One scrollable page with a button on it.

SECTION ORDER

	SECTION	WHAT GOES IN IT
01	Hero	What you do, for who. Your Pillar 1 sentence. Plus the button.
02	Work	Your two or three blocks. This is most of the page.
03	Process	Three to five steps. What happens after they pay.
04	What to expect	Turnaround, how you communicate, what you need from them, what's not included.
05	Pricing	Three tiers side by side. Each one has its own button.
06	FAQ	The six questions on the next page.
07	Contact	One email or one form. Not four options.

YOUR PROCESS, IN YOUR WORDS

Answer these six

Every unanswered question is a reason to close the tab. Write the answers before anyone has to ask.

1 HOW LONG DOES IT TAKE?

2 WHAT DO YOU NEED FROM ME TO START?

3 HOW MANY REVISIONS?

4 WHAT IF I DON'T LIKE IT?

5 DO YOU DO [THE ADJACENT THING PEOPLE ALWAYS ASK FOR]?

6 WHAT HAPPENS AFTER YOU DELIVER?

TECHNICAL CHECKLIST

- ☐ All images compressed — WebP or AVIF, under 300 KB each
- ☐ Images below the fold set to lazy-load
- ☐ Loads in under three seconds on mobile data — test it on your phone, off wifi
- ☐ Works on a small phone screen with no horizontal scroll
- ☐ Hover states and micro-interactions on the work blocks
- ☐ One custom detail that isn't in any template

THE BUTTON

- ☐ Stripe payment link created and live
- ☐ Button in the hero, and on every pricing tier
- ☐ Link in every social bio you have
- ☐ Same link at the end of every post

CONSTRAINT

The button ships before the page is finished. A rough page with a working button beats a beautiful page with a contact form.

Volume

The page is the shop. Posting is the street it sits on. One post a day, inside your slice.

Thirty posts is not thirty projects. One piece of work carries a week of posting if you cut it into angles — a rebrand is the logo, then the site, then the two together, then the version you rejected. That's four posts and one afternoon of work.

The point isn't volume for its own sake. It's that you cannot find out which format earns you the best return on your time until you've run several. So this pillar is a loop, not an instruction.

THE WEEKLY LOOP

STEP		
01	Pick one piece of work	A redesign, a rebrand, a single component. Small counts.
02	Cut it into angles	Four or five ways to show the same thing. Use the menu below.
03	Post one angle a day	Same link at the end, every time.
04	Note what moved	Which angle produced reach, and which produced clicks and replies. They're rarely the same one.
05	Next week, repeat	More of what worked, plus one format you haven't tried yet.

THE ANGLE MENU — TICK WHAT YOU'VE TRIED

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ The artifact on its own | ☐ The version you rejected, and why |
| ☐ Before and after | ☐ The business problem, not the pixels |
| ☐ A detail crop, one line on why | ☐ A teardown of a product in your slice |
| ☐ Rough to final, three states | ☐ Same work, different medium |

CONSTRAINT

One week per piece of work, and at least three different angles tried by the end of the month. The variety is what teaches you something — thirty posts in one format tells you nothing except that you can post.

Thirty days

Two things worth tracking, and they are not the same thing.

WEEK	POSTS	BEST ANGLE	REACH	LINK CLICKS	ENQUIRIES	QUALIFIED
1						
2						
3						
4						

Reach is fuel, not the outcome. Most of the people engaging with design work are other designers, and that's fine — it's the cheapest way to get volume, and volume raises the odds that someone who can hire you scrolls past. Impressions and followers are worth having.

What they aren't is a substitute for the right-hand columns. Don't read a good week of reach as a good week of business, and don't wait until the numbers are big to expect clients. Plenty of people get work with an audience far smaller than they think they need.

CONSTRAINT

Thirty days before you judge any of it. Under thirty days you are reading noise and calling it evidence.

WHICH ANGLE EARNED THE MOST FOR THE TIME IT COST?

The three-click test

Open your own post as if you were a stranger. Time yourself.

post → profile → link → page → paid

- ☐ Is there a link in the bio, visible without tapping “more”?
- ☐ Does the link go straight to the page — not a linktree, not a homepage?
- ☐ Is a price visible without scrolling past three sections?
- ☐ Can they pay without talking to you first?

WHERE DID IT BREAK?

Fix that one thing before anything else on this sheet. A broken link in a bio has quietly cost more designers more money than bad design ever has.

Run it again every time you change something. The path breaks silently — a redirect, a platform update, a bio rewritten at midnight. Once a month, be a stranger to your own work for two minutes.

Fourteen days

Paralysis is the real enemy, not difficulty. One thing a day, in this order.

DAY	DO THIS	DONE
1	Write your slice sentence	☐
2	Write your three tiers and the price ladder	☐
3–5	Make or finish your two or three work blocks	☐
6	Create the Stripe payment links	☐
7–9	Build the page	☐
10	Compress everything, test on your phone off wifi	☐
11	Write the FAQ and the process section	☐
12	Update every bio with the link	☐
13	Run the three-click test, fix what broke	☐
14	First post — then post every day for thirty days	☐

If you fall behind, don't restart. Pick up on the day you're on. The order matters more than the calendar — the reason the button comes before the finished page is that a live button changes how you build everything after it.

What this doesn't do

It doesn't get you high-ticket clients. It doesn't build a brand. It doesn't replace being good at design — a no-brainer offer attached to weak work is still a no, just a faster one.

What it does is give you a surface a stranger can find, understand, and pay, without you being in the room. Once that exists, everything else — raising prices, narrowing further, building the referral loop, choosing who you want to work with — has something solid to stand on.

Start at the entry tier. Deliver five.
Raise the price. Repeat.

THE ONE-PAGE SUMMARY

- ☐ **Slice** one surface, one type of company, one sentence
- ☐ **Offer** three tiers, an uncomfortable entry price, a ladder decided in advance
- ☐ **Proof** two or three blocks, mostly visuals, labelled honestly, not all one layout
- ☐ **Page** one page, fast, live Stripe button above the fold
- ☐ **Volume** one redesign concept a day, same link every time, thirty days before judging

NOTES

Sharing is caring

This worksheet spends fifteen pages arguing that you should make one action obvious and easy. It would be strange to end it with nothing to do.

So: one action.

Follow along on LinkedIn and X

LINKEDIN

[linkedin.com/in/charles-postiaux](https://www.linkedin.com/in/charles-postiaux)

X

x.com/PostiauxCharles

I post design work, teardowns, and what's working and not working in building a design business — which is the same loop this sheet describes, run in public. If you're doing the thirty days, that's the easiest place to see the formats in the angle menu actually used.

If you post something from this worksheet, tag me. I read everything.

If you want more. The Designer's Toolkit is a paid collection of the resources, references and tools behind the work — \$29, if and when it's useful. It isn't needed for anything in this worksheet. Finish the fourteen days first.

baobunstudio.gumroad.com/l/designer-toolkit